

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. — Leave & Time-Off Policy

Section 1: Purpose / Definition

At AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd., we recognize that sustained innovation in Artificial Intelligence and Deep Tech requires a healthy, balanced, and well-rested workforce. The Leave & Time-Off Policy establishes a structured, transparent framework for time away from work. This policy is designed to encourage employees to take regular rest, recover from illness, manage personal obligations, and celebrate significant life events, all while maintaining organizational productivity and operational continuity.

Section 2: Scope

This policy applies to all permanent, full-time and part-time employees of AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. operating in India, whether working on-site at our Pune headquarters or under approved hybrid and fully remote arrangements. Contract personnel, vendors, and external consultants are governed by the time-off clauses specified in their respective independent service agreements and are not covered under this corporate policy.

Section 3: Eligibility

Leave entitlements are mapped to the standard calendar year, running from January 1 to December 31.

- **Permanent Employees:** Eligible for all leave categories detailed herein from their official date of joining.
- **Pro-rata Calculations:** For employees joining mid-year, leave entitlements (specifically Privilege Leave, Casual Leave, and Sick Leave) are credited on a pro-rata basis calculated from their exact date of appointment through December 31.
- **Interns and Trainees:** Eligible for a modified allocation of 1.5 days of general stipend leave for every completed month of service, and are not eligible for leave accumulation or encashment.

Section 4: Rules & Guidelines

4.1 Leave Categories and Allocations

AstraNova provides a comprehensive suite of leave options to accommodate various personal and professional circumstances:

Leave Type	Annual Allocation	Crediting Frequency	Carry-Forward Rules
Privilege Leave (PL)	18 Working Days	1.5 days per month	Max 30 days carried over; excess lapses.
Casual Leave (CL)	12 Working Days	Full quota on Jan 1	Lapses entirely on Dec 31; no carry-forward.
Sick Leave (SL)	12 Working Days	Full quota on Jan 1	Lapses entirely on Dec 31; no carry-forward.
Maternity Leave	26 Calendar Weeks	Per incident basis	Statutory mandate; no carry-forward.
Paternity Leave	2 Calendar Weeks	Per incident basis	Must use within 6 months;

			no carry-forward.
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4.2 Key Operational Regulations

- **Privilege Leave (PL):** Designed for planned vacations and extended rest. PL must be applied for at least two weeks in advance. It cannot be clubbed with Casual Leave (CL). A maximum of 30 unused PL days can be carried forward to the next calendar year; any excess beyond 30 days lapses automatically on December 31. PL accumulation is encashable only upon separation from the Company.
- **Casual Leave (CL):** Intended for sudden, unforeseen personal matters. CL can be taken for a maximum of three consecutive days. Unused CL balances cannot be encashed or carried forward.
- **Sick Leave (SL):** Reserved strictly for medical recovery and health issues. If SL extends beyond two consecutive working days, the employee must submit a digital copy of a valid medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner upon resuming duty.
- **Maternity & Paternity Leave:** Fully paid leaves aligning with statutory frameworks. Maternity leave applies to eligible female employees as per the Maternity Benefit Act. Paternity leave provides two continuous weeks for new fathers (including through legal adoption) to be utilized within six months of the child's birth or placement.

Section 5: Process / Workflow

To maintain production stability across software sprints and client deployments, all leave requests must follow this formal sequence within the Human Resources Information System (HRIS):

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Employee checks leave balances and submits a formal request via the
HRIS portal
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HRIS cross-references dates against mandatory blackout windows (e.g.,
critical product releases)
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Reporting Manager reviews team delivery schedules and calendar
coverage

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Manager issues a digital Approval **or** Rejection via the HRIS portal
↓
HRIS automatically updates the employee's profile, balances, **and**
shared out-of-office calendar

Note: For unplanned Sick Leave or emergency Casual Leave, the workflow must be initiated within 24 hours of returning to work.

Section 6: Roles & Responsibilities

- **Employee:** Proactively manage leave balances throughout the year. Coordinate planned absences with team members to ensure backup coverage. Set up appropriate out-of-office notifications and hand over pending development or engineering tasks.
- **Reporting Manager:** Review and respond to leave applications within 48 hours of submission. Monitor team leaves to prevent burnout while ensuring sprint goals and client deadlines are met without disruption.
- **HR Department:** Administer leave compliance in the HRIS framework, execute annual reconciliation of carry-forward balances, audit medical certifications, and calculate final settlement encashments.
- **Leadership Team:** Establish annual corporate holiday calendars and authorize temporary company-wide operational shutdowns if required.

Section 7: Exceptions

- **Compassionate / Bereavement Leave:** In the event of the loss of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, or sibling), AstraNova provides up to 5 consecutive days of paid Compassionate Leave. This does not deduct from the employee's standard PL, CL, or SL balances and requires manager notification.
- **Loss of Pay (LOP) Leave:** If an employee faces extraordinary medical or personal crises and has exhausted all accrued leave balances, they may apply for Loss of Pay leave. This requires written validation and joint sign-off from the Department Head and the HR Director.
- **Statutory Extensions:** Any adjustments required due to localized legal mandates or changing state labor rules will override standard caps, subject to HR review.

Section 8: Examples

- **Scenario A (Planned Vacation):** A Senior Machine Learning Engineer plans a 10-day trip in November. The engineer discusses this with their team during the quarterly planning session, designates a backup developer for their active code repositories, and submits a 10-day Privilege Leave request in the HRIS three weeks before departure. The manager approves the request.
- **Scenario B (Unplanned Emergency):** An employee experiences a sudden household emergency. They drop a message on their team Slack channel by 9:00 AM IST to notify their manager, take the day off, and submit a 1-day Casual Leave request via the HRIS the following morning.
- **Scenario C (Extended Medical Recovery):** A technical writer undergoes an emergency surgical procedure requiring five days of absolute bed rest. The employee or a family member informs the manager on day one. Upon returning on day six, the employee uploads a medical fitness certificate to the HRIS alongside their 5-day Sick Leave application.

Section 9: Important Notes

- **Avoid:** Do not club Casual Leave and Privilege Leave together in a single application sequence, as the HRIS system will automatically flag and reject the transaction.
- **Avoid:** Do not plan non-refundable international or domestic travel before your Privilege Leave is formally approved in the HRIS portal by your reporting manager.
- **Best Practice:** Distribute your Privilege Leaves across the four quarters of the year to prevent a heavy accumulation of leaves in December, which can conflict with year-end delivery goals.

Section 10: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1: How many total days of leave am I entitled to in a full calendar year?

A1: A permanent employee receives a total of 42 working days of standard leave per calendar year: 18 days of Privilege Leave, 12 days of Casual Leave, and 12 days of Sick Leave.

Q2: Can I cash out my unused Casual Leaves at the end of the year?

A2: No. Casual Leaves are meant for immediate personal needs and cannot be encashed or carried forward. Unused balances lapse entirely on December 31.

Q3: What happens if I have 35 days of unused Privilege Leave on December 31?

A3: The maximum carry-forward allowance for Privilege Leave is 30 days. On December 31, 30 days will transfer into the new calendar year, and the remaining 5 days will lapse automatically.

Q4: When does my annual leave balance get credited to my account?

A4: Casual Leave and Sick Leave balances are credited in full on January 1 of each year. Privilege Leaves accrue progressively at a rate of 1.5 days for every completed month of service.

Q5: Am I allowed to use Sick Leave to take care of an ailing family member?

A5: Sick Leave is strictly reserved for the employee's own medical recovery. For taking care of family members, employees should utilize their Casual Leave or planned Privilege Leave allocation.

Q6: Is there a minimum notice period required for applying for long vacations?

A6: Yes. For any planned Privilege Leave exceeding three consecutive working days, you must submit your application via the HRIS portal at least two weeks in advance.

Q7: Can I take half-day leaves at AstraNova?

A7: Yes, both Casual Leave and Privilege Leave can be applied for as half-days (First Half or Second Half) through the HRIS portal to accommodate brief personal appointments.

Q8: What happens if I run out of all my leave balances but need more time off for an emergency?

A8: You may request Loss of Pay (LOP) leave through the HRIS. This requires justification and explicit joint approval from your Department Head and the HR Director.

Q9: Do public holidays falling during my leave period count as leaves?

A9: If a declared AstraNova national or regional holiday falls within your approved Privilege Leave period, that specific day is excluded from the deduction and is not counted as a leave day.

Q10: What documentation is required if I am on Sick Leave for three consecutive days?

A10: For any Sick Leave that extends beyond two consecutive working days, you must upload a scanned copy of a valid medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner to the HRIS portal when you return.